Individual Take Sync Group

User Manual

Emelowsky Plugins • document version 2.3 (Individual Take Sync Group 2.2.0) • October 2026

Table of Contents

1. What this script does
2. Installation
3. First run
4. Main window
5. Creating a group
6. Managing groups
7. Sync toggles (Volume / Pan / Mute / Phase / Fade)
8. Search field and warnings
9. License activation
10. DEMO version limitations
11. Options panel
12. Backups and configuration export/import
13. Multiple interface languages
14. Troubleshooting

1. What this script does

Individual Take Sync Group is a REAPER script that synchronizes splitting, moving, trimming, deleting and active-take changes of items across corresponding positions on multiple tracks at once. It is built primarily for multitrack recordings where the same performance (e.g. a vocal take captured on several microphones, or multiple doubled takes of the same part) lives on several tracks simultaneously and needs to stay aligned through editing.

Instead of manually repeating every cut and move on each track separately, a single edit on any track that belongs to a group is automatically mirrored to every other track in the same group.

Requirements

- REAPER 7 (latest stable version recommended) or REAPER 6 — on REAPER 6 use the file from the “Lua 5.3 (REAPER 6)” folder of the package (details in “Individual Take Sync Group - REAPER 6 (Lua 5.3) PLEN.txt”).
- The ReaImGui extension (version 0.9 or newer), installed via ReaPack.
- Optional: the js_ReaScriptAPI extension (via ReaPack). With it, “always on top” windows don't flicker while you move them, go behind another program when you click it, and REAPER questions always show above the script windows. Without it the script works normally.

DEMO and full version — one file

The script is a single file: Emelowsky - Individual Take Sync Group.lua. Without a license it runs right away as the DEMO — window title “Individual Take Sync Group — DEMO”, a “⚠ DEMO VERSION ⚠” banner with an “I have a key - activate” button, and a limit of 2 groups with 6 tracks/items each (chapter 10). Once you activate a license (chapter 9), the same file works as the full version right away, with no limits — nothing to reinstall, your groups stay.

2. Installation

The script is a single .lua file — installing it means pointing REAPER to that file as an action. The package has two folders: “Lua 5.4 (REAPER 7)” and “Lua 5.3 (REAPER 6)” — use the file from the folder for your REAPER version.

- Open Actions → Show action list...
- Click New action... → Load ReaScript...
- Select the Emelowsky - Individual Take Sync Group.lua file from the package (preferably copied first into a Scripts/Individual Take Sync Group/ folder in REAPER's resource folder: Options → Show REAPER resource path...).
- The script now appears in the action list under its full name (Emelowsky - Individual Take Sync Group).

Action List window showing the added script

Installing with ReaPack (instead of copying by hand): Extensions → ReaPack → Import repositories… and paste https://raw.githubusercontent.com/Emelowsky/reapack/main/index.xml, then Extensions → ReaPack → Browse packages… → search for “Individual Take Sync Group” → tick “Emelowsky - Individual Take Sync Group” (on REAPER 6: “Emelowsky - Individual Take Sync Group (REAPER 6, Lua 5.3)”) → Install → Apply. Updates then arrive by themselves (Extensions → ReaPack → Synchronize packages).

Note — different folder: ReaPack installs the file into Scripts/Emelowsky/Individual Take Sync Group (with an extra “Emelowsky” folder), not Scripts/Individual Take Sync Group as in the manual install, and adds the action to the Action List for you — skip steps 1–4. Pick one way of installing; the groups are saved in the project, so they work with both.

Assigning a keyboard shortcut (recommended)

The script is a window that can be shown or hidden at any time with the same shortcut. Select the action in the Action List and assign a free shortcut with Add... In the shortcut dialog, set Scope to Global + text fields — this way toggling the script window keeps working even while the keyboard focus is on a text field inside the script's own window.

3. First run

On first launch (without a license) the main window opens right away as the DEMO — with the "⚠ DEMO VERSION ⚠" banner and the "I have a key - activate" button. Nothing opens by itself: the empty group list shows a short hint on where to start.

Already have a license? Click "I have a key - activate" — the activation window opens (chapter 9). After activation the window works as the full version right away.

Main window in the DEMO (banner with the "I have a key - activate" button)

4. Main window

Main script window with its areas labeled

The main window is divided into a few fixed areas:

- Toolbar at the top — two small, circular buttons: a green “+” (tooltip “New group”) and a blue “G” (tooltip “Group templates”, see chapter 6, “Group templates”). Rename and Delete group are available only from the right-click menu on the group row (see chapter 6). The Select group from selection button has been removed — replaced by continuous, automatic highlighting of matching groups (see chapter 6).
- Search field — filters groups, tracks and items at the same time as you type (parts of words work too, chapter 8).
- Group list on the left — each group row shows, from left to right: a live color circle (read from the colors of the members’ tracks/items), a small green circular “+” button (adds the currently REAPER-selected items/tracks to the group, and restores any previously excluded ones — tooltip “Add selected items/tracks”), a small red circular “–” button (COMPLETELY removes the currently REAPER-selected items/tracks from THIS group — they also disappear from the group's member list; to only stop syncing some items and keep them in the group, use “Exclude selected items from this group” in the right-click menu, see chapter 6), and finally the group’s name. The row no longer shows a member count or an exclusion count in brackets — just the name, plus a [paused] tag when the group is paused.
- No permanent panel on the right anymore — where that panel used to be, the main window now shows a hint: “Double-click a group to see its item/track list.” Double-clicking a group row opens a separate, resizable pop-up window listing that group’s tracks/items (see chapter 6).
- Bottom bar — Pause all and Options are small circular icon buttons; the Options button opens and closes the Options window (Options open = button highlighted). Conflict detection runs in the background (chapter 8). In the DEMO the bar shows the limits and a Buy license button, in the full version a discreet active-license note in the bottom-right corner.

You move the window by grabbing the title bar or any empty space. Docking: drag the window with Shift held down onto a spot in REAPER's docker; you take it out of the docker with a normal drag or right-click on the title bar → Undock. By default the windows stay always on top, but only over REAPER: when you click another program they go behind its window, and come back on top when you return to REAPER. REAPER warnings, questions and dialogs always show above the script windows. A docked window is not “always on top”.

5. Creating a group

Clicking the green "+" button (New group) opens a form with a single field — the group name. A new group is always created in "Items" mode: it is a list of MANUALLY PICKED ITEMS — other items that happen to sit on the same tracks are NOT part of the group and are never touched. When a group member is split, both newly created parts automatically become members too — no need to add them by hand.

New group form — name only

Once a group exists, the green “+” button on its row in the group list (see chapter 4) adds the currently selected tracks/items in REAPER to it and restores any previously excluded ones, while the red “–” button completely removes the currently selected items from it.

Note on older projects: the sync engine still fully supports the older "Tracks" mode (a group = one whole selected track — every item sitting on it is automatically part of the group) for groups created in earlier versions of the script or loaded from an older backup or export. A new group just can't be created in that mode from the current interface anymore.

6. Managing groups

- Renaming — now only from the right-click (PPM) context menu on the group row: select exactly one group, right-click it, and choose Rename. The toolbar button is gone.
- Deleting — now only from the right-click context menu on the group row (works on multiple selected groups too) or the Delete key — either way, a confirmation prompt appears showing how many groups will be removed.
- Duplicating — creates a copy of the group together with its list of tracks/items, named with a "(copy)" suffix; available from the right-click context menu on the group row.
- Right-click context menu on a group row — offers, in this order: Rename (single selection only), Duplicate, Move up / Move down (single selection only), the five sync toggles plus the Pause toggle (checkbox-style entries showing [X]/[ ] — see chapter 7), “Exclude selected items from this group” (single selection only — the items stop syncing in this group but stay on its list), and finally Delete (works on multi-selection too, with a confirmation popup showing the count). There is no separate “restore excluded items” entry anymore — restoring happens automatically whenever you use the green “+” add button (see chapter 4) on previously-excluded items.
- Multi-select — groups in the list can be selected one at a time, with Ctrl to add/remove from the selection and Shift to select a range, the same way files behave in a system file browser.
- Continuous highlight matching the REAPER selection — the Select group from selection button has been removed. Instead, any group whose members overlap the current REAPER selection gets a continuous, automatically-updating highlight border in a distinct color, independent of the normal “selected in the list” border. The highlight updates live as the REAPER selection changes — no button needed anymore.
- Clicking a group row (a single, plain click, without Ctrl/Shift) — selects that group in the list and simultaneously selects all of its current members in REAPER. This is a one-time action, not a persistent lock: if you then select something else in REAPER, that new selection is not overwritten. A convenient way to quickly see what’s inside a group.
- Double-clicking a group row — opens a separate, resizable pop-up window listing that group’s tracks/items (this replaces the old, always-visible side panel, see chapter 4). Each track/item row inside that pop-up is clickable and selects the corresponding track/item in REAPER without closing the pop-up, so you can click through several members in a row.
- Clicking empty space in the group list (not on any row or button) — deselects all groups. Previously at least one group was always selected and this could not be cleared.
- The Insert key — creates a new group (the same action as clicking the toolbar’s green “+” button) — a keyboard shortcut for convenience.
- Pausing/resuming sync — any group can be paused temporarily via the Pause entry (checkbox [X]/[ ]) in the right-click context menu on the group row, without losing its configuration. A paused group is marked [paused] and does not sync until resumed.
- Pause all — a small icon button in the bottom bar, pauses/resumes syncing for ALL groups at once, regardless of each group's individual state.
- Group color — read live from the colors of the group's member tracks/items (shown as a colored circle next to the group name) — if members have different colors, the circle splits into proportional slices.

Group order — the wider group always goes higher

The order of groups in the list is their hierarchy: when the same track or item belongs to several groups, the group placed higher wins. So the group that ties together more tracks has to sit above the narrower groups. Example: an “All” group with every track plus “Vocals” and “Drums” groups — put “All” at the very top of the list, with “Vocals” and “Drums” below it. If “All” is at the bottom of the list, it won't sync all the tracks.

Rule: from the widest group at the top down to the narrowest at the bottom. Change the order with Move up / Move down in the right-click menu on a group row (with one group selected). It's easiest to create the groups in that order right away — “All” first, then the narrower ones.

Group templates

A group template is a saved list of group NAMES only — no items or tracks. It's handy when you set up the same groups in session after session (e.g. “Vocals”, “Backing vocals”, “Guitars”). Templates are shared across all projects.

The blue circular “G” button on the toolbar opens the templates window, where you can:

- Save the current groups as a new template — type a template name and click Save (only the group names are stored).
- Load — adds empty groups with the template's names to the current project. Groups whose name already exists in the project are skipped.
- Edit — rename the template and edit its list of group names: order (Move up / Move down), removing a name, and Add group name. Back to template list closes the editor.
- Delete — deletes the template; the first click changes the button to “Confirm?”, the second click deletes it.

After loading a template, add items to the groups as usual — with the green “+” button on the group row.

7. Sync toggles (Volume / Pan / Mute / Phase / Fade)

Besides the core structural sync (split, move, length, active take), every group has five independent toggles for extra parameters. These are no longer icons shown directly in the group row — the toggles are now accessed as checkbox-style entries ([X]/[ ]) in the right-click (PPM) context menu on the group row (see chapter 6). Each toggle can be switched on or off separately per group:

- Volume — syncs the item's volume level.
- Pan — syncs the pan setting.
- Mute — syncs the mute state.
- Phase/Invert — syncs phase inversion.
- Fade — syncs fade in/out, both curve shapes and both lengths.

A toggle that is off means that parameter can be set independently on each track in the group without affecting the others — the structural sync (cut positions) keeps working regardless of the state of these five toggles.

8. Search field and warnings

Search field

The field at the top of the window filters groups, tracks and items at the same time as you type — each result shows which group it belongs to. You can type several words or parts of words separated by spaces, in any order — only results containing all the typed parts are shown (case-insensitive), e.g. “gtr dbl” finds “DBL Gtr L”. Clicking a result selects the matching item/track in REAPER. The search text is not cleared when you click a result, so you can click through several results without retyping.

Warnings

The conflict-detection engine still runs in the background and continuously detects situations it cannot unambiguously mirror — for example a missing matching part on one of the group's tracks, or a new item that appeared on a track in a way other than a split (e.g. pasted in or freshly recorded). This version of the interface, however, no longer has a dedicated button or panel for viewing a list of these situations — detection now happens purely in the background, with no visible UI element for it.

9. License activation

The license is tied to a specific computer (Machine ID) and an e-mail address. You get the product key in the customer panel after buying on Gumroad. At activation and from time to time afterwards the script checks with the license server whether the license has been revoked. No internet or no contact with the server does not get in the way — the script keeps working normally and never deactivates the license for that reason.

- Click “I have a key - activate” next to the DEMO banner (or Options → License → “I have a key - activate”) and copy your Machine ID with the Copy button.
- Open the customer panel (the “Open customer panel” button in the activation window, or plugins.emelowsky.com) and log in with your purchase e-mail and the Gumroad license key from your purchase confirmation e-mail.
- Enter your Machine ID in the panel — it gives you a product key (a long string of characters).
- Paste the product key into the key field of the activation window, enter the SAME e-mail address and click Activate. The window works as the full version right away, no restart — your groups stay.

Activation window with the Machine ID / e-mail / product key fields

After activation the License section in Options shows Active license (e-mail address) — the same text also appears discreetly in the bottom-right corner of the main window. You can deactivate the license at any time with Deactivate license (e.g. before moving it to another computer) — it asks for confirmation, and the script goes back to the DEMO.

The Machine ID is tied to ONE SPECIFIC computer — the same product key will not work on a different machine.

Moving your license to another computer

New computer, or your Machine ID changed (e.g. after reinstalling the system)? Move your license in the customer panel — the “Open customer panel” button is at the bottom of the License section (also on the activation screen). In the panel you get a new key for the new Machine ID, and the license on the previous computer is revoked. The number of self-service transfers is limited — when you run out, contact the seller.

Revoked license

If the license is revoked (e.g. after moving it to another computer, or after a refund), the script tells you right away and switches to the DEMO, and the activation window and the License section keep showing “This license has been revoked by the license server…”. The same key works again only if you restore the license to this computer in the customer panel — the script checks this with the server when you activate. Otherwise you need a new key from the customer panel or to contact the seller.

10. DEMO version limitations

Without an active license the script runs as the DEMO, fully functional in every feature described above (creating and managing groups, all five sync toggles, the search field, warnings, backups, export/import) — the only limit is QUANTITY:

- a maximum of 2 active groups at the same time,
- a maximum of 6 tracks or items per group.

Trying to go over the limit (creating a 3rd group, adding a 7th track/item to a group — including by splitting an item that's already a member) shows a message about the limit. The DEMO never deletes data: groups and members over the limit (e.g. after deactivating the license) stay saved and are skipped by the sync — they come back after activation. The DEMO bottom bar always shows the current limits and a Buy license button that opens the store page.

DEMO version bottom bar showing the limit notice and the Buy license button

11. Options panel

The Options panel opens with the Options button in the main window's bottom bar (the same button closes it; Esc also closes Options, keeping your changes). At the very top of the panel are the logo and a row of interface language buttons (PL / EN / DE / FR / ES) — the change is instant and covers the whole interface. Below are collapsible sections (click a section header to expand it), in this order:

General

- Check frequency (s) — how often the script checks for track changes. 0.00 means checking on every UI frame (as fast as possible); with a very large number of groups/tracks/items, raise this value if you notice slowdowns.
- Match tolerance (samples) — the margin of error used when matching corresponding parts between tracks.
- Debug: log sync operations to REAPER's console — useful only when reporting a bug to the seller.

Font

Font family, text size and the overall UI scale.

Window

- Corner rounding (0–20 px) — separate sliders for buttons and fields, sliders, and windows and popups.
- Selection border — a border around the currently selected row in the group list, independent of its background color: thickness, rounding and color are set separately. A thickness of 0 disables the border entirely.
- “Main window always on top” and “Popup windows always on top” (both on by default; with the js_ReaScriptAPI extension only over REAPER, without it over other programs too) and “Popups always on the script's screen” (the first time in the center of the script window, then wherever you left them).

Colors and Button colors

The interface color palette (background, text, list rows, etc. — by default the colors of the whole Emelowsky Plugins family), plus the option to give selected script buttons their own custom color, independent of the general theme.

Maintenance

- Backup every (min) — how often a periodic backup of all groups is written in the background (see chapter 12).
- Restore from backup... — loads a chosen backup file, replacing ALL current groups with its contents (requires confirmation).
- Export groups... / Import groups... — save/load the group configuration to a separate file (see chapter 12).
- Restore default look — resets ONLY the visual settings (colors, font, rounding) to the default look, without touching the groups themselves.

License

Always the last section in the panel: license status, Machine ID, “Deactivate license” (in the DEMO: “I have a key - activate” and “Buy license”) and the “Open customer panel” button — described in detail in chapter 9.

Options panel with the Window section expanded (border settings visible)

12. Backups and configuration export/import

The script protects the group configuration in two independent ways:

Automatic backup

- Synchronous backup — written automatically after EVERY change to the groups (adding/removing a member, renaming, pausing, etc.). Requires no action from the user.
- Periodic backup — written in the background at the interval set in Options → Maintenance → Backup every (min), independent of user actions.
- If something goes wrong (accidentally deleted a group, project data got corrupted), either backup can be loaded with Restore from backup in Options → Maintenance — after choosing a file and confirming, ALL current groups are replaced with the contents of that backup.

Export and import

Unlike automatic backups (meant for recovering data within the SAME project), export deliberately saves the group configuration to a separate file so it can be moved — to a different project or a different computer. Since new groups are now created exclusively in "Items" mode (see chapter 5), import in that mode only works within the same project the export was made from. Older exports containing "Tracks"-mode groups (from earlier versions of the script) still import correctly — for those, the script tries to match tracks by name if the original identifiers don't match (e.g. importing into a different project).

13. Multiple interface languages

The interface is available in five languages: Polish, English, Spanish, German and French. The language switches instantly with the buttons in the row at the very top of the Options panel — the change applies to the entire interface (buttons, labels, messages) and is remembered between sessions.

14. Troubleshooting

- "This script requires the ReaImGui extension" — install ReaImGui via ReaPack (Extensions → ReaPack → Browse packages..., search for "ReaImGui") and run the script again.
- “Always on top” covers other programs, or the windows flicker while you move them — install the js_ReaScriptAPI extension (via ReaPack); with it the windows stay on top only over REAPER and don't flicker.
- An item on one of the tracks stopped syncing — the most common cause is a new item that was created some way other than splitting an already-synced part (e.g. pasted in from elsewhere) — such an item isn't automatically covered by the sync. Detection of these cases still runs in the background (see chapter 8) — there is no longer a separate Warnings panel to check its list.
- Can't add another group/track/item in the DEMO version — this is the intended, permanent DEMO limitation (see chapter 10), not a bug.
- “This license has been revoked by the license server…” — restore the license to this computer in the customer panel and paste the same key again, or get a new key in the customer panel; if in doubt, contact the seller (chapter 9).
- Changed computers, or your Machine ID changed — move your license in the customer panel (chapter 9, “Moving your license to another computer”).
- The interface look got messed up after changes in Options — Options → Maintenance → Restore default look resets the factory visual settings without touching the groups.
- Suspecting a sync bug — enable Options → General → Debug: log sync operations to REAPER's console, reproduce the problem, and send the full contents of the "ReaScript console output" window to the seller along with a description of what happened.
- The script doesn't start on REAPER 6 — use the file from the “Lua 5.3 (REAPER 6)” folder of the package (or the ReaPack package “Emelowsky - Individual Take Sync Group (REAPER 6, Lua 5.3)”); the file from the “Lua 5.4 (REAPER 7)” folder only works on REAPER 7.
- The window doesn't go into the docker — drag it with Shift held down (chapter 4).
- A group that covers every track (e.g. “All”) doesn't sync all the tracks — move it to the very top of the group list (right-click → Move up); a wider group has to be above the narrower ones (chapter 6, “Group order”).